

Should children drink more water?: the effects of drinking water on cognition in children.

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While dehydration has well-documented negative effects on adult cognition, there is little research on hydration and cognitive performance in children. We investigated whether having a drink of water improved children's performance on cognitive tasks. Fifty-eight children aged 7-9 years old were randomly allocated to a group that received additional water or a group that did not. Results showed that children who drank additional water rated themselves as significantly less thirsty than the comparison group ($p=0.002$), and they performed better on visual attention tasks (letter cancellation, $p=0.02$; spot the difference memory tasks, $p=0.019$ and 0.014).